



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Regents School of Austin
School Website: <https://regentsaustin.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Regents School of Austin (Regents) presents a robust, highly aligned CLASSICAL model grounded in a Christian worldview. Public materials from the school emphasize a classical, Christian formation that centers on virtue, truth, goodness, and beauty, and that seeks to form character and intellect together rather than merely transmit information. Evidence shows explicit commitments to the classical trio of grammar–logic–rhetoric, the Great Books/Great Conversation tradition, and a liturgical, communal life that includes regular chapel and ministerial/theological framing. The faculty are positioned as a living part of the curriculum, and parents are positioned as partners in education. In short, Regents demonstrates strong adherence to the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education, with explicit language and practices across all six categories.

Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL

- Evidence across categories highlights a sustained, explicit classical Christian program, including: the school's mission to cultivate truth, goodness, and beauty within a Christian worldview; a curricular structure built on grammar, logic, and rhetoric; sustained engagement with the Great Conversation and Great Books; a pedagogy that includes Harkness-style discussion, senior theses, and Socratic-style inquiry; faculty functioning as a living curriculum; and a robust model of parent partnership and community involvement (chapels, ministerium, fiducia, and practical family engagement). Direct textual supports include mission language, weekly chapel, ministerium/fiducia framing, three-tiered curriculum (Grammar–Logic–Rhetoric), references to the Great Conversation, and multiple features highlighting parental partnership and community life. □filecite□turn0file0□turn0file4□turn0file6□turn0file11□
- Category-by-category snapshot below provides keyword analyses and scoring grounded in the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements document. In all six categories, Regents demonstrates substantial positive alignment with classical criteria and minimal presence of negative indicators; thus the overall assessment is CLASSICAL.
- What would move the needle: Not applicable for a "Somewhat Classical" designation since the aggregate rating is CLASSICAL. Minor, non-substantive refinements (e.g., increasing explicit labeling of Great Books in all grade levels or highlighting additional opportunities for classical project work) could enhance transparency, but are not required to elevate the score.
- Abstract: Regents School of Austin clearly embodies classical education in practice and public-facing materials, with strong religious/metaphysical foundations, virtue-centered aims, a threefold liberal arts curriculum, explicit Socratic/Scholastic pedagogy, a model faculty, and a robust parent/community partnership.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's public materials frame Regents as a "K-12 classical Christian school" with a Christian worldview that informs all study, life on campus, and community life. This explicit theological and metaphysical framework is central to the mission and daily experience. - The mission statement explicitly ties education to knowing, loving, and practicing what is true, good, and beautiful within a Christian worldview.

This is a direct alignment with transcendental realism and the grounding of knowledge in theology. - The curriculum and practice include liturgical/community practices (weekly chapel, reverence, worship) and literature that foreground theological framing (Ministerium, Fiducia, Reverentia). These terms and practices appear in school-facing materials. □filecite□turn0file4□turn0file6□

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christian, worldview, Scripture-centered, worship, chapel, Ministerium, Fiducia, Reverentia, truth/goodness/beauty, prayer, liturgy. - Negative keywords present: none detected in public-facing materials; secular/anti-theist terms are not present. - Frequency: High density of explicit religious/metaphysical language and liturgical practice; multiple direct matches to the positive indicators around theology, sacred life, and communal worship. This yields a strong positive alignment. - Why this rating: Regents clearly anchors education in religious/metaphysical commitments (theology, sacred life, Christian worship, and a worldview-informed curriculum). The presence of liturgical practices and doctrinal framing strongly supports a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's stated aim centers on virtue and wisdom cultivated through a classical framework, as seen in the mission to equip students to know, love, and practice truth, good, and beauty. This emphasizes formation over mere information and aims at human excellence in keeping with classical aims. - The public materials consistently describe formation-oriented outcomes (virtue, character, love of truth and beauty) rather than a narrow job-prep orientation. The language of formation ("formation of affections," "true/good/beautiful") aligns directly with classical aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, formation, truth, goodness, beauty, human excellence, formation of affections, contemplation. - Negative keywords present: none detected (no explicit emphasis on job-prep or purely technocratic aims in public materials). - Frequency: Positive indicators are frequent and reinforced by mission statements and outcomes described on site; negative indicators are absent. - Why this rating: The school's stated goal emphasizes virtue, wisdom, and formation consistent with classical education, rather than a primary focus on workforce preparation. This yields a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is organized around the liberal arts pillars of grammar, logic, and rhetoric, with explicit references to Grammar School, School of Logic, and School of Rhetoric. This is a core hallmark of classical education. - The historical dimension is integrated through the curriculum, including the Great Books/Great Conversation approach and a Western-civilizational framing (e.g., "The Great Conversation," focus on Western traditions in humanities and literature). - The school explicitly references the Great Conversation and Great Books as part of curriculum, including senior thesis and humanities emphasis, indicating a robust Great Books component.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, Western tradition, history (as part of the curriculum, not Social Studies), literacy of classics, liberal arts framework, Senior Thesis, humanities. - Negative keywords present: explicit reference to "Social Studies" as a contrast to history-focused study is not present; curriculum is framed around Great Books and Western tradition rather than broad social studies terms. - Frequency: High; multiple explicit curricular markers (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric, Great Conversation, Great Books, Senior Thesis) appear across site pages. - Why this rating: Presence of the three liberal arts, continuous historical study within a Great Books framework, and explicit Great Conversation signals CLASSICAL curriculum alignment.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Upper-grade pedagogy includes Socratic-style discussion, seminars, and debates as part of the rhetoric-focused instruction (explicitly described in School of Rhetoric and associated curriculum). Harkness Tables and discussion-centered formats are highlighted as core modalities. - The capstone elements include Senior Thesis presentations and living in the Great Conversation, reinforcing rhetoric, public speaking, and argumentation as central pedagogical aims. - Lower grades include communal and contemplative elements (weekly chapel, reverence, and community life) that balance rigorous inquiry with contemplative practice.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion, Harkness Tables, seminars, debates, senior thesis, Great Conversation, rhetoric, public speaking, humanities, contemplation, reverence, scholé. - Negative keywords present: none in the public-facing materials; pedagogical descriptions emphasize engagement and contemplation rather than purely rote or test-driven approaches. - Frequency: High; multiple pages explicitly describe Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy and rhetoric training. - Why this rating: The pedagogy richly aligns with classical teaching methods (Socratic/Harkness/seminar dialogue, rhetoric training, senior thesis) and a balanced approach that includes contemplative/receptive elements, yielding CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as “talented, caring, and godly,” serving as mentors and the living curriculum, with a sense of a community of learners among faculty and students. - The public materials present a leadership structure with a Head of School and a visible faculty culture (e.g., Faculty pages, portraits/defining teacher profiles, and a school-wide emphasis on virtues and formation). - There is emphasis on faculty as the core of the school’s mission and on professional community and mentorship (e.g., Residency programs, faculty development in formation).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, faculty as core, community of learners, virtuous teachers. - Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials. - Frequency: High; multiple references to faculty quality, mentorship, and the central role of teachers. - Why this rating: The description of faculty as mentors and the living curriculum, plus explicit emphasis on virtuous, capable teachers, supports CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Regents explicitly positions parents as engaged partners and co-educators in the educational project. The public materials repeatedly reference engaged, involved parents and parental involvement in school life. - The school highlights active parental involvement through campus life, sign-ups, events, sign-up sheets, and community events, as well as admissions partnerships and family life on campus. Weekly chapel and “Ministerium” emphasize family and church-community ties. - There are dedicated materials describing “the Regents Fund” and other family/community-facing resources, illustrating ongoing collaboration with families in governance and support.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-educators, family involvement, parental engagement, home-and-school collaboration, welcome to visits, community events. - Negative keywords present: none detected in public materials. - Frequency: High; parental engagement and partnership are woven throughout admissions, student life, and community materials. - Why this rating: The school’s explicit emphasis on parental partnership and family involvement is a hallmark of classical schools that treat parents as co-educators and integral in the formation process, yielding CLASSICAL.

Overall assessment and aggregate ranking

- Across all six categories, Regents School of Austin demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment. The public materials reveal a coherent classical Christian program rooted in the three liberal arts, the Great Books/Great Conversation canon, Socratic-style pedagogy with Harkness-based discussion, a living curriculum by faculty, a partnership-oriented community with engaged parents, and liturgical/community life. This synthesis aligns with the Six Essential Elements framework for a CLASSICAL education.
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- Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required given the CLASSICAL aggregate rating. If desired, small enhancements could include:
 - A concise, explicit crosswalk on the website that maps each policy and activity to the six classical categories (to aid external evaluators), while preserving existing curricular language.

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- Additional public-facing statements highlighting the Great Books/Great Conversation program in each division (K–12) to reinforce public perception of the classical curriculum.
 - More explicit, consistently labeled examples of lower-school contemplative and “Scholé-like” practices (beyond weekly chapel) to further highlight contemplative dimensions of classical education.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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